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Roles in IT Service Management (ITSM)

Roles & Service Desk 2025

ITSM Role(s)

- A role is a collection of specific responsibilities and privileges
- A role is held by individuals or teams
- A single person *can* have multiple roles

What do we need different roles?

Why Roles?

- The **communication** between the core business and IT operations can be improved by clearly defined roles, **responsibilities** related to roles and **powers** which is a prerequisite for **collaboration** and provides an improved relationship.

Service Provider

- The organisation providing a service is a service provider.
- A service provider can be part of the same organisation as a consumer (for example, an IT department offering services to a sales team) or an external organisation (for example, a software solutions provider selling to Customers)
- A service provider must understand who its customers or consumers are, and which other stakeholders are part of its wider service relationships. (Agutter 2019)

Service Consumer (benefitter)

The service consumer/benefitter is the person or organisation that is receiving a service. Most organisations will act as service providers and service consumers as part of normal service delivery (for example: as a consumer they buy components to build a service they provide as a service provider).
Consumer is a broad term that includes customer, user and Sponsors. (Agutter 2019)

Stakeholder

A stakeholder is "*a person or organization that has an interest or involvement in an organization, product, service, practice, or other entity*." (Agutter 2019)

Different stakeholders - different types of value

Stakeholder	Value example
Service consumer	Receives benefits, optimises costs and risks.
Service provider	Funding or loyalty from consumers, further business development, reputation enhancement.
Service provider employees	Job satisfaction, financial and non-financial rewards, personal development.
Society and community	Employment, taxes, corporate social responsibility initiatives.
Charity organisations	Financial and non-financial contributions.
Shareholders	Financial benefits, such as dividends.

Other roles

Customer	*"A person who defines the requirements for a service and takes responsibility for the outcomes of service consumption."*
User	*"A person who uses services."*
Sponsor	*"A person who authorizes budget for service consumption."*

Service Relationship

A service relationship is "**a co-operation between a service provider and a service consumer"**. Service relationships include service provision, service consumption, and service relationship management.

Several service relationships can exist in a service ecosystem.

How to keep track of roles?

Tool: RACI clarifying roles

- In order to clarify roles and responsibilities, a so-called **RACI matrix** can used for each process.
- First, define roles and then distribute them in an appropriate manner

Responsible

- The person or people responsible for correct execution **– for getting the job done**

Accountable

- **Owns the task** (ownership of quality and the end result). He or she signs of the work that the responsible provides.

Consulted

- Reviews and provides with advice and authorization for the task

Informed

- Receives updates as the task progresses

RACI – Example

	Business Executive	CIO	Business Process Owner	Chief Architect	Head of Development	Head of ITO	Compliance	Service Manager
Build an IT Service Catalogue	I	A	C	I	C	C	I	R
Define SLAs for critical services	I	C	C	I	R	R	C	A/R

ITSM Organisational Units

NOTE – A UNIT IS ALSO A **PRACTICE**!

Organisational units(now practice)

A **organizational unit** is according to OGC (2011) an **unit that is:**

- Self contained subsets of an organization
- Intended to accomplish specific tasks
- Takes the form of a team or group of people (and the tools being used)
- Add structure and stability to organizations
- Supported by budget and reporting structures
- Depends on practices/processes

Example of Organisational units

Application Management

- End to end management of applications
- Executes and is supported by different ITIL core processes

IT Operations Management

- Deals with the day-to-day development and maintenance of the IT infrastructure and facilities
- Console management, Backup and restore operations, Media management, Batch job execution, maintenance of the facilities

ITSM Organisational units

Technical Management

- procurement, development, and management of the technical skill sets and resources
- Ensure that the provider has the right skill sets available to co-create the services

Service Desk

- *The service desk manages contact between the service provider and the users. A typical service desk manages incidents and service requests and also handles communication with the users.*
  - Example of responsibilities: Incident management, Service Requests, Change Requests etc
  - Interface that relates on good communication, relationships

Service Desk

- "The purpose of the service desk practice is to capture demand for incident resolution and service requests. It should also be **the entry point and single point of contact** for the service provider with all of its users." (Agutter 2020)
- Plays a central role because it is the IT Department's public face to the users.
- If users have a low confidence in user support, it means often that the credibility of the entire IT operations is low.

Service Desk Tasks

Acknowledge: the user needs to know that their contact has been received; for example, issues reported via email could receive an auto-acknowledgement.

Classify: classification helps the service desk to understand what they are dealing with and how important it is.

Own: ownership ensures no issue or request gets ‘lost’ between teams or systems.

Act : resolving things to the user’s satisfaction.

Service Desk

- A service desk will be the users' only channel, a focal point, in the IT Department, a **Single Point Of Contact** (SPOC).
  - E.g., Reached on one single phone number,
  - E.g., One single email address
- A service desk is also important to get away from **informal** contacts with the IT Department
- The function also serves as the IT Department´s channel to reach out with information about the status of an incident, new or changed IT services and scheduled downtime.

What channels can a service desk use?

Possible service desk channels include:

- Telephone
- Service portals
- Mobile applications
- Live chat and chatbots
- Email
- Walk-in
- Text messages and social media messaging
- Public and private discussion forums

Guidelines for Service Desk staff

1. *Keep* a service-minded attitude.
2. *Understand the customer* and collaborate with customers
3. Remind yourself that customer service is EVERYONE'S business.
4. Get a clear understanding of the problem
5. Apologize
6. Make things right (incident management)
7. Ask if there is anything else you can do
8. Follow up after you've resolved the problem
9. Inform the customer (communicate)
10. Fix the cause of the problem
11. Keep a record of which customers need some extra nurturing
12. Use metrics and dashboards

Thank you!